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CAN KIM JONG-UN CONTROL HIS NUKES?

Nuclear Safety, Accident, and the Specter of North Korea's Atomic Arsenal

I.

There probably weren't many global travelers waiting for flights out of Pyongyang International Airport on August 29, 2017, but if there were, their early morning reveries were undoubtedly startled by the spectacle of a North Korean intermediate-range missile blasting off only a few miles beyond the runways. Just before six in the morning, a Hwasong-12 missile, also known as the KN-17, with a purported range of nearly four thousand miles, arced northeastward over North Korea and the Sea of Japan.[1] Eight minutes later, it passed over Hokkaido, the northernmost of Japan's four home islands. Roughly six minutes after that, approximately 730 miles east of Hokkaido, it broke apart and fell into the Pacific Ocean. If the trajectory of the KN-17 had

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